

APRIL NEWSLETTER

5 APRIL 2022



WELCOME TO OUR 2022 COMMITTEE

Thank you to the outgoing committee members for 2021. They had a challenging year as we navigated through our second year of living with a pandemic resulting in lockdowns and continually changing COVID rules and regulations.

Our new committee will meet each month to oversee the upper management decisions of the organisation. The daily operations of the service are Elizabeth and Kareen's responsibility.

President: Patricia Banyer

Vice President: Chontelle Niness

Treasurer: Clare MacGregor

Secretary: Catherine Wiencke

Ordinary members: Eleanor Newman,
Lauren McRae & Sue Ray

SICKNESS & THE CONTINUAL WET

There has been a large increase in the number of viruses around due the extended period of time children and adults are spending indoors.

The educators have increased the cleaning of all surface areas, toys, etc., to help reduce the spread of infections. Please keep your child at home if they are showing any signs or symptoms of being unwell. In addition, please call the service to inform us of your child's illness as we have reporting responsibilities to the NSW Early Childhood education & Care Department as well as NSW Health.



CHANGES TO PRE-SCHOOL PLACEMENTS

The NSW Government is providing funding for 2 days of free preschool for 2022. To reflect these funding arrangement preschool funded positions will be limited to 2 days a week for any new enrolment or changes to an existing enrolment. If families would like to book additional days for their preschool child, they can do so under the long day care Federal Government funding.

95% CCS REBATE FOR TWO OR MORE CHILDREN ENROLLED IN EARLY CHILDHOOD EDUCATION

Reminder about reduced costs for LDC fees for families with 2 children under the age of 6 years. This will bring the daily rate of Pre School LDC fees to \$8.60 and Early Years Learning Centre fees to \$9.12. Please see Robyn if you want any fees assistance in this area.

PARENT TEACHER INTERVIEWS

The meetings occur formally twice a year. All families should have received a date and time to meet their child's teacher. These are a great opportunity to exchange information about your child's current skills and interests and plan together with the teacher about goals you would like them to reach or work towards over the next 6 months. If you have not received information on this, please call your child teacher to schedule a time.

POSITION VACANT

We are currently advertising for a Cert III in Children's Services Trainee. The traineeship will be an 18 month contract.

An application form is available on our website: www.gloucesterpreschool.com.au

PLAYGROUP DATES

Gloucester CWA...Tues 5 Apr

Coolongolook...Wed 6 Apr

Booral...Tues 26 Apr

Gloucester CWA...Tues 3 May

Coolongolook...Wed 4 May

Booral...Tues 10 May

Gloucester CWA...Tues 17 May

Coolongolook...Wed 18 May

Booral...Tues 24 May

DATES TO REMEMBER

- **Last day of Preschool Term 1—Friday 8 April**
- **First Day Preschool Term 2—Tuesday 26 April**
- **Vacation Care—Mon 11 April—Friday 22 April**
- **The Service will be closed: Good Friday, 15 April; Easter Monday, 18 April; & ANZAC Day, 25 April.**
- **Committee Meeting—Thursday 28 April, 7-9pm at the Preschool**

EQUIPMENT PURCHASES

Stretcher Bed Sheets



Children's knives



XPLOR APP

The Xplor app has many functions beyond the signing in and out facility. The classroom educators are often sharing photos and updates about what is happening, areas of current learning & events that occur throughout the day. In addition, the admin team use it send out important messages about what is happening within the service as a whole.

Parents can add their comments, information and feedback both publicly and private to the senders. They can also upload information or photos on special family events that they would like to share with their child's teacher.

If you are not receiving these messages or would like help with using the app to its full potential please see your child's classroom teacher or talk with Robyn.

POLICIES REVIEWED THIS TERM

* Acceptance and Refusal of Authorisations Policy * Enrolment Policy * Social Media Policy *Grievance Policy

SURVEY RESULTS ON REDUCING COVID RESTRICTIONS AND ACCESS TO THE SERVICE'S PREMISES.

Thank you to all the families that completed the short survey.

The results showed:

Morning arrivals. I would like this to look like:
34 responses



Afternoon collections of children. I would like this to look like:
34 responses



At this stage, no decision has been made to change arrangements due to the rise in COVID cases and warnings from the NSW Department of Education & Care to keep current practice in place, which is to limit access to the service where possible.

We will continue to closely monitor the COVID cases and will review again before the commencement of term 2, Tuesday 26th April.

DAPIN ROOM NEWS

After hearing about Lismore floods (first time) the children in our class were shown a photo of a preschool that had been inundated by flood water. We looked at all of the resources stacked up on the footpath and thought about how we can show kindness to others. It was decided that we would draw them a picture that we called 'a happiness poster' and send them a gift of books. Posting out package involved an excursion to the Post Office.

Thankyou to all of the families that attended our parent teacher chats. The shared information will be used as learning goals for the children. -Jenny, Jac & Jed



GAWUL ROOM NEWS

The Gawul Room have had a busy month, the children have been exploring different medias of sensory play. Shaving foam and watercolors, cloud dirt dough and melting ice rainbow. These mindful activities kept the children very engaged. Sensory play encourages learning through exploration, curiosity, problem solving and creativity.



The Gawul Team Barney, Rashelle and Olivia

The Garden and Animal projects books have seen children showing photos of their pets and gardens for news, this creates interest in communicating between the children and their experiences from home. We have started a pet photo wall and the children revisit it throughout the day. Thankyou to the families that have sent these photos in, we would love to see photos from all our Gawul families. Children feel safe when they see familiar things around them, and by having picture's of themselves, families or pets on the wall helps them build a sense of security in their physical environment.



We have been making fresh juices following the Interest in the garden project book, children have been able to try healthy fresh foods in different forms. Fresh, cooked or juiced. This has been a highlight for the children.



FOR SALE

Second-hand fridges for sale - \$100 each.

Please contact Robyn if you would like to purchase.



SCHOOL READINESS ASSESSMENTS 2022

GLOUCESTER

WILL YOUR CHILD BE STARTING SCHOOL IN 2023?

Gloucester Community Health is offering a free School Readiness Assessment of your child's general health & development.

This is for all children who will attend kindergarten at Gloucester PS, St Joseph's, Barrington PS and Stratford PS.

IF YOUR CHILD IS CURRENTLY ENROLLED IN A PRE-SCHOOL, YOU WILL AUTOMATICALLY RECEIVE A LETTER WITH AN APPOINTMENT

For more information please contact the Centre on:

65385058



Recipe of the Month—Veggie Sausage Rolls (Mushroom + Lentil)

Ingredients:

For the filling

- 2-3 cloves garlic (crushed)
- 1 onion (finely diced)
- 1 tablespoon fresh thyme
- 2-3 tbsp. olive oil
- Salt and pepper
- 500 grams finely diced mushrooms
- 1¼ cup breadcrumbs
- 2 cups baby spinach leaves (chopped)
- 1 cup canned lentils
- 1½ cups tasty cheese (grated)
- ½ cup nutritional yeast flakes
- 1 egg

For the pastry

- 3 sheets puff pastry
- Extra egg, for brushing
- 2-3 tablespoons sesame or poppy seeds

Method:

1. Pre-heat oven 180 °C and line two oven trays with baking paper. Set the frozen puff pastry aside on a bench to thaw while you prepare the filling.
2. Place the mushrooms in a feed processor and blitz until finely chopped/minced.
3. Place the garlic, onion, thyme and olive oil into a medium frying pan with the salt and pepper and fry over medium heat for 2-3 mins. Add the mushrooms and stir over med-high heat until tender.
4. Place the mushroom mixture into a large mixing bowl with the other filling ingredients. Using your hands or a large spoon, mix the ingredients together until completely combined.



To Roll

- Place the thawed puff pastry squares on a board and cut each sheet in half through the middle, making six pastry rectangles.
- Divide the filling evenly between each of the pastry rectangles, using your hands to mould a sausage shape length-ways along the middle.
- Brush a little beaten egg along the long edge of the pastry and then roll pastry over the filling, sealing the ends by gently pressing them together.
- Brush the top of each roll and sprinkle with sesame seeds. Using a sharp knife, cut each roll into 6 portions (or to desired sizes) and place them onto the prepared baking trays.
- Bake for around 35 minutes, or until the pastry is golden and flaky.
- Serve while hot with some tomato sauce or homemade chutney. Enjoy!